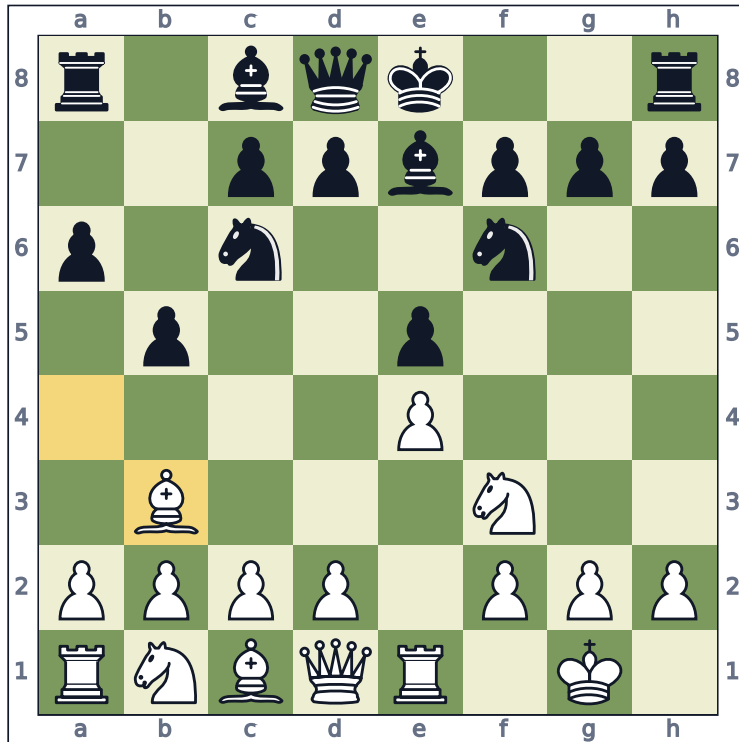


## ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

# Ruy Lopez

ECO C88 | 9 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.55 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C88 covers Ruy Lopez. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Ruy Lopez: Closed.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

**PIECE MAP**

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named C88 line

This section preserves all 9 names and defining routes assigned to C88 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**001 Ruy Lopez: Closed**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3

**002 Ruy Lopez: Closed**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 O-O

**003 Ruy Lopez: Closed, Alekhine Gambit**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 Na5 9. Bc2 c5 10. d4 Qc7 11. Nbd2 O-O 12. Nf1 Bg4 13. Ne3 Bxf3 14. Qxf3

**004 Ruy Lopez: Closed, Anti-Marshall**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 O-O 8. a4

**005 Ruy Lopez: Closed, Balla Variation**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 Na5 9. Bc2 c5 10. d4 Qc7 11. a4

**006 Ruy Lopez: Closed, Leonhardt Variation**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 Na5 9. Bc2 c5 10. d4 Qc7 11. h3 Nc6 12. d5 Nb8 13. Nbd2 g5

**007 Ruy Lopez: Closed, Rosen Attack**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. d4

**008 Ruy Lopez: Closed, Trajkovic Counterattack**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 Bb7

**009 Ruy Lopez: Noah's Ark Trap**  
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. d4 Nxd4 9. Nxd4 exd4 10. Qxd4 c5